

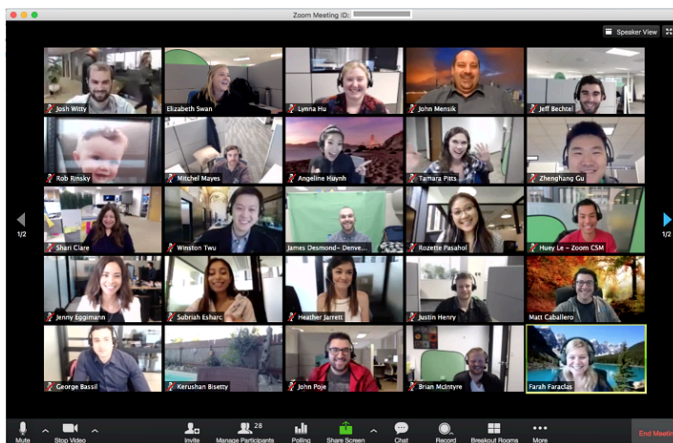
Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps VS Visual Collaboration Tools: Which One Should You Use?



Image Credit: [Value Prop](#)

In this day and age, communication happens online due to the ongoing pandemic and advancement in technologies. These tools for communication include the two things in this article, which are cloud-based video conferencing apps and visual collaboration tools. What do these tools do? Here is what you need to know.

Definition



(Picture Source: [Owl Labs Blog](#))

What are cloud-based video conferencing apps? It is a cloud-based digital idea that provides users a high definition online meeting with anyone who has internet access. Examples of cloud-based video conferencing apps are [Zoom](#) and [Google Meet](#).



(Picture Source: [Time Doctor Blog](#))

On the other hand, visual collaboration tools is a practice of work collaboration that is driven by technology, one example of such tools are [ClickUp](#) and [Google Jamboard](#).

Common Features & Unique Characteristics

Here are some of the **common features** that **cloud-based video conferencing applications** can bring:

- **Customizable backgrounds:**
Users can change their backgrounds into any picture.
- **Icons that appear on the main page:**
Provide functions such as 'schedule a meeting' or 'start an instant meeting'.
- **Option to share screens during an online conference or meetup:**
Allow users to share important topics or presentations during an online conference.
- **Video and audio conferencing:**
Users can speak directly to each other while having their cameras turned on.

Next are the **common features** that **visual collaboration tools** provide:

- **Virtual whiteboarding:**
Users can use a virtual whiteboard for illustration.
- **Diagramming:**
Users can insert diagrams into the whiteboard.

- **Screen sharing:**
Provide screen sharing options for personal presentations.
- **Sticky notes:**
Users can create notes for reference purposes.
- **Commenting:**
Users can place share their opinions on the uploaded work.
- **Video and audio conferencing:**
Users can talk to each other directly.

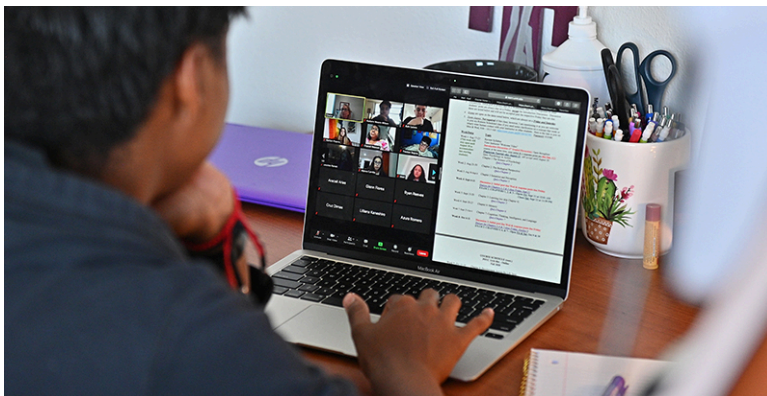
Benefits In Different Scenarios



(Photo Source: [Oppida](#))

1. Work Discussions

Work discussion involves presentations and illustrations of diagrams like profit and loss reports or the customer base to aim, and using visual collaboration tools such as ClickUp suits this scenario as employees can receive information more clearly.



(Photo Source: [The 74](#))

2. School Lessons

School meetups spend most of the time sharing screens on teaching materials. In this scenario, using both cloud-based video conferencing apps like Google Meet and visual collaboration tools such as Google Jamboard works. This is because schools can use Google Meet if the lesson only requires the ability to share screens, while they can use Google Jamboard for tutorial classes that require a further breakdown of information.



(Photo Source: [Business Insider](#))

3. Family Meetups

Family meetups are simple; it requires only the ability to turn on their cameras and speak, and using cloud-based video conferencing apps would be a great idea as they are more than enough to set up a family meeting.



(Photo Source: [Ateki](#))

4. Business Conferences

Business conferences normally consist of graphs or reports, and visual collaboration tools such as ClickUp is great as their function include creating marketing plans, strategies and tasks. It is also suitable for project-based work such as an in-house freelance team as the tasks given would be straightforward for every team member on the platform.

Pros & Cons

Here are some advantages and disadvantages that these tools normally have:

Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps	
Advantages	Disadvantages
● Cost-Efficient - Users can communicate from home, hence saving the costs of operating in the office.	● Lack Of Direct Interactions - Although users can see each other through cameras, it might feel unnatural.
● Increased Efficiency - Users can work from their homes, and they can complete the day-to-day task without time barriers.	● Insecure Meetings - Hackers might sabotage the system, allowing random strangers to enter private meetings.
● Ability To Screen Share - Users can present their files through sharing screens which are similar to what a physical meeting can do.	● Hard To Gather Data - It is hard for users to receive information from recorded meetings as sometimes the recordings may be too long.

Visual Collaboration Tools	
Advantages	Disadvantages
● Universal Access - Real-time documents and notes indicate that the workplace is easily accessible at any time.	● Miscommunication Might Happen - Miscommunication happens especially when technical issues arise.
● Sufficient Tools - Features such as whiteboard and project management give users sufficient functions for presentations.	● Low Group Potency - Lack of a physical workplace would lead to fewer interactions, which makes complex tasks complicated.
● Increased Flexibility - Users that can access to the platform is limitless, meaning more experts can come together and solve the same issues online.	● Confusion Might Happen - Tasks on the visual collaboration tool might confuse the team as the message conveyed might not be clear enough.

Final Takeaways

To sum things up, cloud-based video conferencing apps and visual collaboration tools have common features such as the ability to turn on their cameras and speak to other meeting attendees. Yet, they are both different with their unique features like inserting diagrams or scheduling a meeting. These tools have advantages like high cost-efficiency but lack real human interactions because users are staring at the screens without eye contact.

In my opinion, visual collaboration tools have an edge due to the variety of functions available and their ability to manage projects through attaching tasks. Still, no matter if you are planning to use cloud-based video conferencing apps or visual collaboration tools, you need to know why you are using these tools and the purpose

behind them. Just before you go, we have a gift for you. If you want to join a team that is passionate in their respective fields, feel free to check out the link below to sign up as a member on our website now!

[- If you're interested in companies that use visual collaboration tools in Malaysia, sign up here! -](#)

Resources

<https://vizualsymphony.com/what-is-cloud-video-conferencing/>

<https://frescopad.com/visual-collaboration-definition/>

<https://www.g2.com/categories/visual-collaboration-platforms#:~:text=Visual%20collaboration%20platforms%20provide%20an,and%20video%20and%20audio%20conferencing.>

<https://searchcontentmanagement.techtarget.com/tip/8-business-benefits-and-challenges-of-video-conferencing>

Introduction

- A quick definition of what Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps and Visual Collaboration Tools are
- Examples of Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps and Visual Collaboration Tools (Will use the examples here to explain some unique characteristics that each app has)

Characteristics

- The common features of Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps and Visual Collaboration Tools
- Some unique features that certain apps provide (provide some examples using the apps mentioned in the intro to make it relatable when reading the article)
- How Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps and Visual Collaboration Tools can benefit their users in different scenarios (online discussions, team meetings, or project-based meet-ups)
- The pros and cons of using Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps and Visual Collaboration Tools (will link some benefits listed above here)

Final Takeaways

- Things to be aware of when using Cloud-Based Video Conferencing Apps and Visual Collaboration Tools

- Quick summary on their major characteristics, differences and pros and cons that comes together with the benefits
- My personal opinion on which one is better (will have a detailed breakdown and explanation after doing research)